

RideFinder

rides to & from Black Rock City

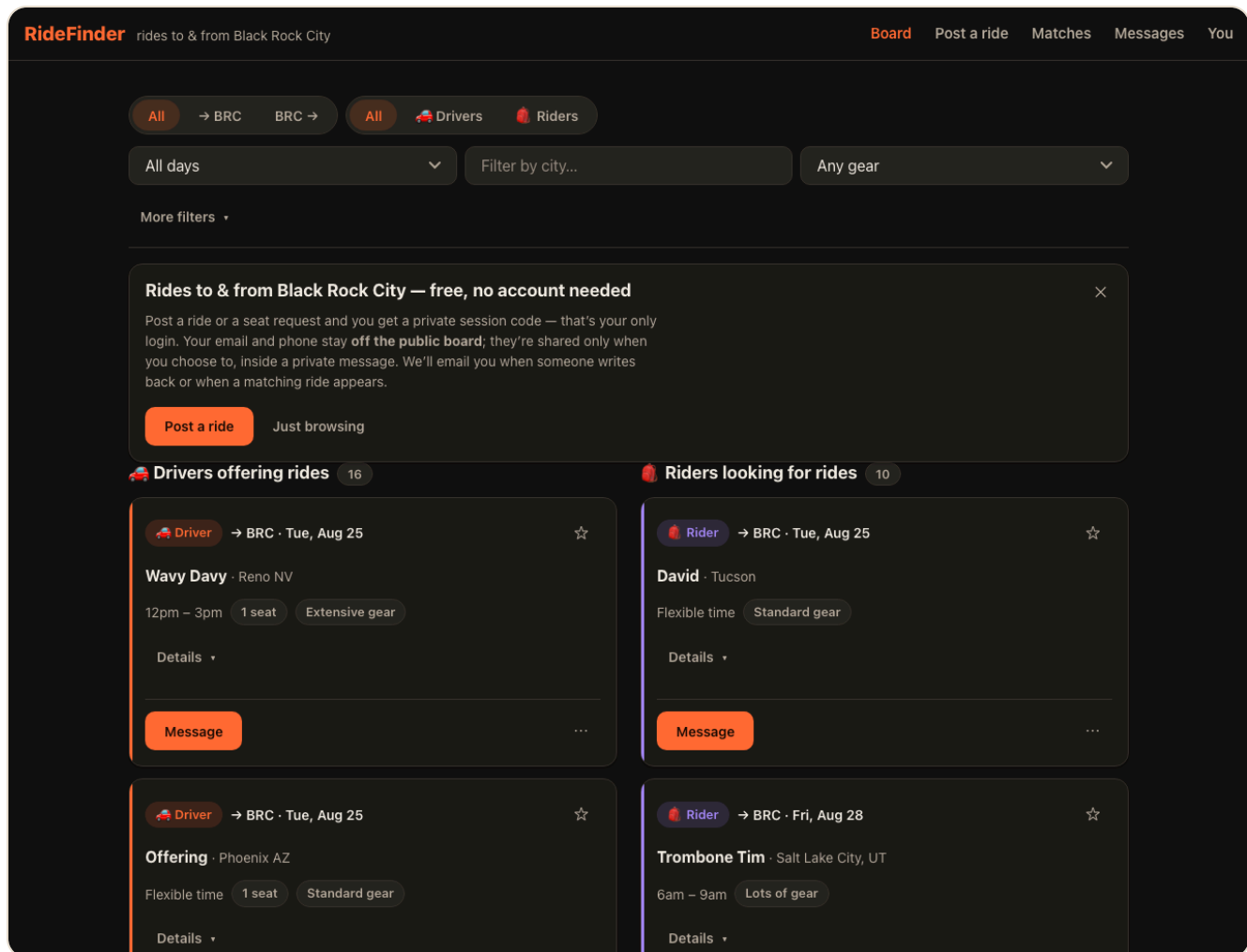
User Manual

Version 2 · July 2026 · ridefinder.site

Three promises: no accounts to create, your contact info stays off the public board, and it keeps working when the connection doesn't. Built by burners, free forever, runs on a phone in a dust storm.

1 The ride board

The board is the whole town square: drivers offering seats on the left, riders looking for seats on the right. No login needed to browse.



The board on a laptop. On a phone, the same five sections live in a bottom tab bar.

Filtering

- **Direction** — All / → BRC (heading in) / BRC → (exodus).
- **Type** — All / 🚗 Drivers / 🚲 Riders.
- **Day, city, gear** — narrow by travel date, departure city, or how much stuff a ride can take (Minimal → Extensive).
- **More filters** — favorites only (tap the ☆ on any card to save it), and “show recently expired” for listings up to a week past their travel time.

Every card shows the route and date up top, the person and city, then seats and gear pills. **Note what’s missing: phone numbers and emails.** Contact happens through private messages (§4) — never on the public board.

2 Posting a ride

Tap **Post**, pick Driver or Rider, fill in the basics. Posting is what creates your session — no signup screen, ever.

RideFinderrides to & from Black Rock City

Post a ride

No account needed — posting creates your private session automatically.

What are you posting?

Driver

Rider

Direction

Going to BRC

Leaving BRC

Your name (or playa name)

Where from / to?

City you're driving from (to BRC) or heading to (from BRC)

Date

Time

dd/mm/yyyy

Flexible time

Seats available

Cargo space

1

Standard — a bin or two

Route details

Stops along the way, preferred route, etc.

Camp info

Camp name & rough address — helps rides find you for exodus

Details

Music, stops, vibes, anything else riders/drivers should know

Board

Post

Matches

Messages

You

FIELD	NOTES
Direction	Going to BRC or leaving it. Leaving-BRC posts ask for your camp address so rides can find you at exodus.
Date & time	Pick a day and a 3-hour window, or “Flexible time.” Listings quietly retire a few hours after the window passes.
Seats / cargo (drivers)	How many people and how much gear you can take.
Your stuff (riders)	Honest gear volume — it’s how matching pairs you with a car that fits.
Contact info	Email and/or international phone (+1 default). Never shown publicly — used for email updates and only shared when you choose (§4).

You can post up to 5 listings a day with 3 active per direction — edit or cancel any of them from the **You** tab.

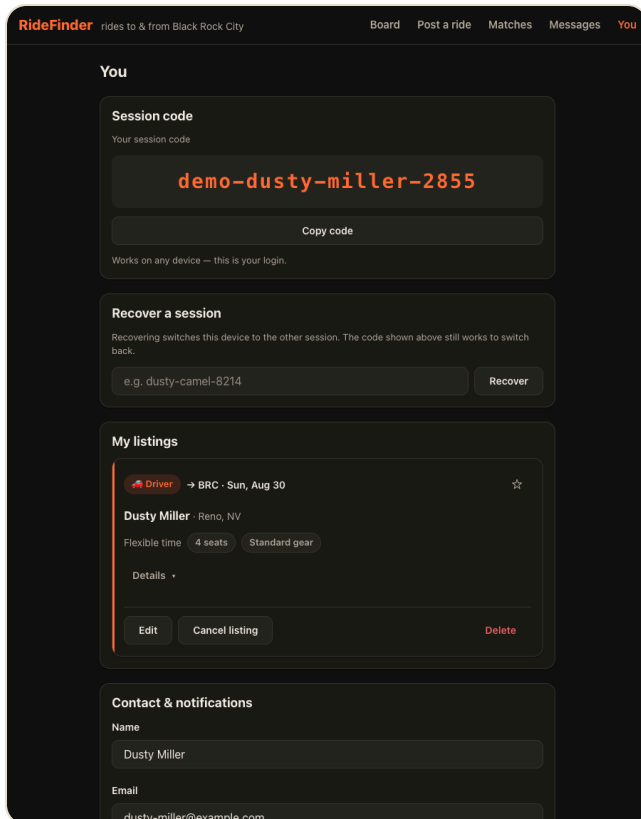
The driver form. Riders get a shorter one (just “how much stuff?”).

3 Your session code — the no-password login

The first time you post, RideFinder shows you a session code like

dusty-camel-8214

That code *is* your account. Screenshot it, write it on your arm — it's the only key.



The You tab: your code (always retrievable here), session recovery, your listings, and email preferences.

Switching devices

1. On the new device, open **You** → **Recover a session**.
2. Type your code (caps and spaces don't matter).
3. That's it — your listings, messages, and matches are there.

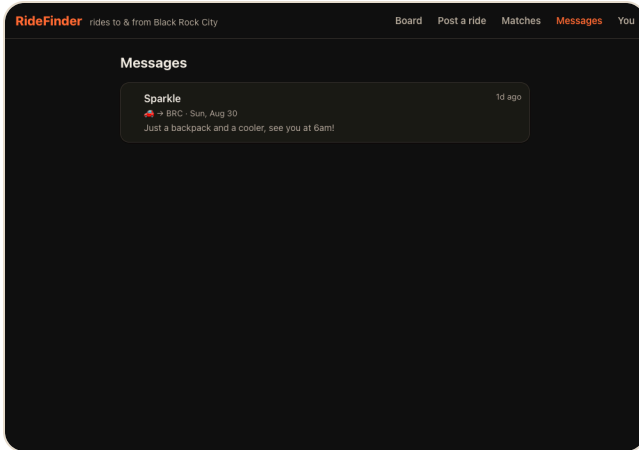
Magic links

Every email RideFinder sends contains links that log you straight into your session — tapping “Reply in RideFinder” from a digest on your phone just *works*, even if you've never opened the site on that phone.

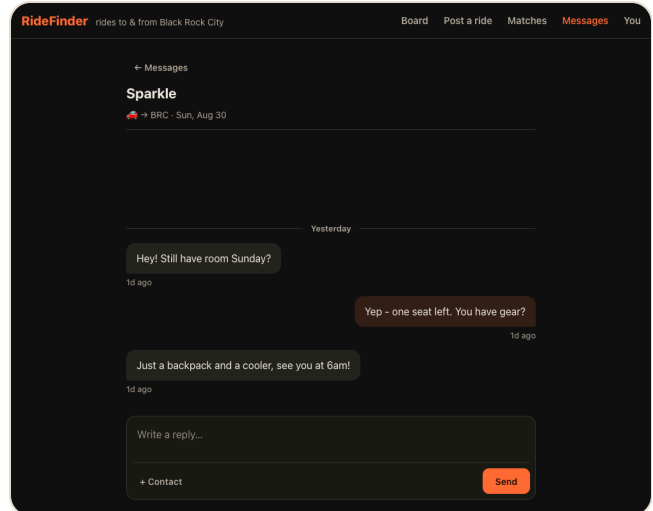
Lost the code *and* the device? If your email is on the profile, any digest email's links will let you back in. Otherwise the session is gone — that's the deal with no accounts.

4 Private messaging

Tap **Message** on any listing. Conversations live in the Messages tab; the other person is notified by email at the pace they chose.



The inbox — unread dots, listing context, last message.



A thread. The 📄 block appears only when someone chose to share contact info.

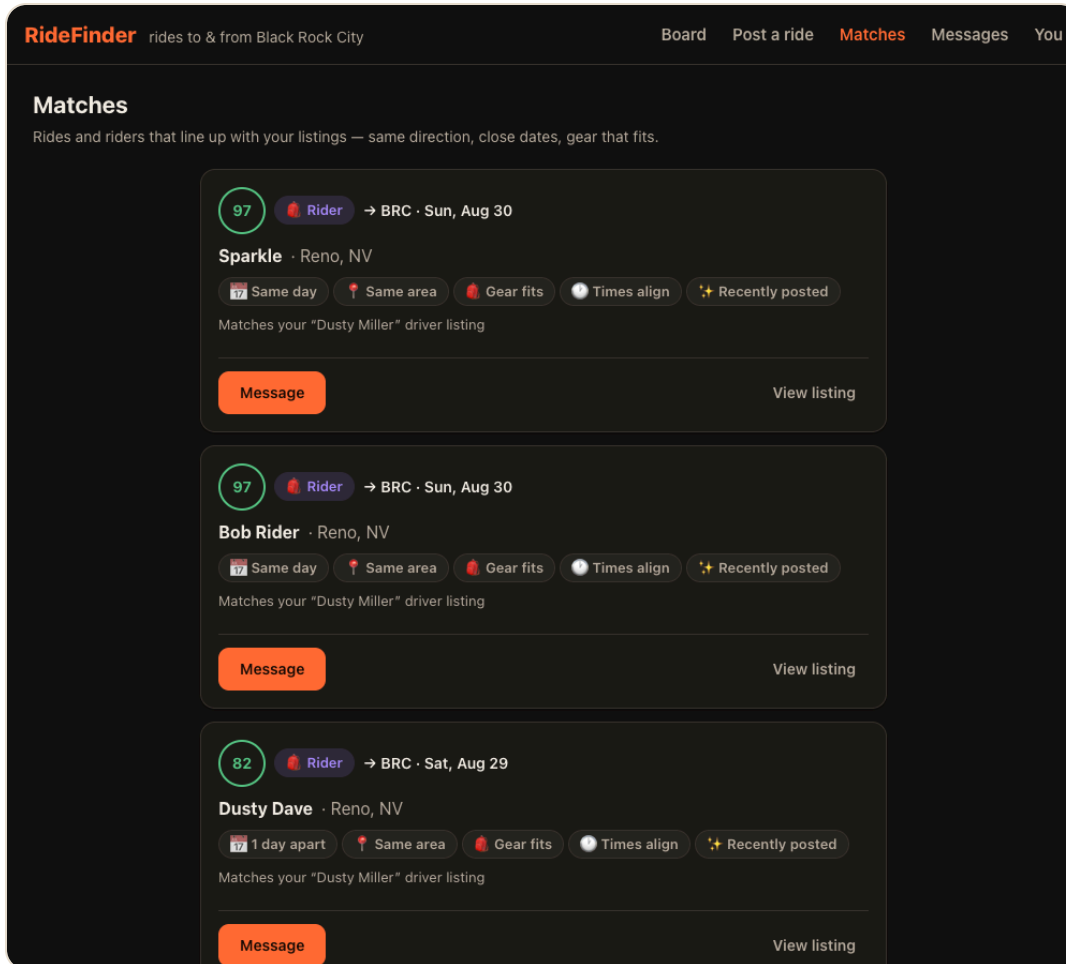
Sharing contact info — per message, on purpose

- Both share toggles are **off by default** on every message.
- Tick “share my email” or “share my phone” and the values from your profile are attached *inside that one message* as tappable links — text, call, or email in one tap.
- The public board never changes. Only the person you messaged sees it.

Housekeeping limits keep the board friendly: a handful of new conversations per hour, a short pause between messages. You'll never notice unless you're a robot.

5 Matches — the board reads itself

Whenever a listing is posted or edited, RideFinder scores it against every compatible listing going the same direction: date closeness, departure area, whether the gear physically fits, time-window overlap, freshness.

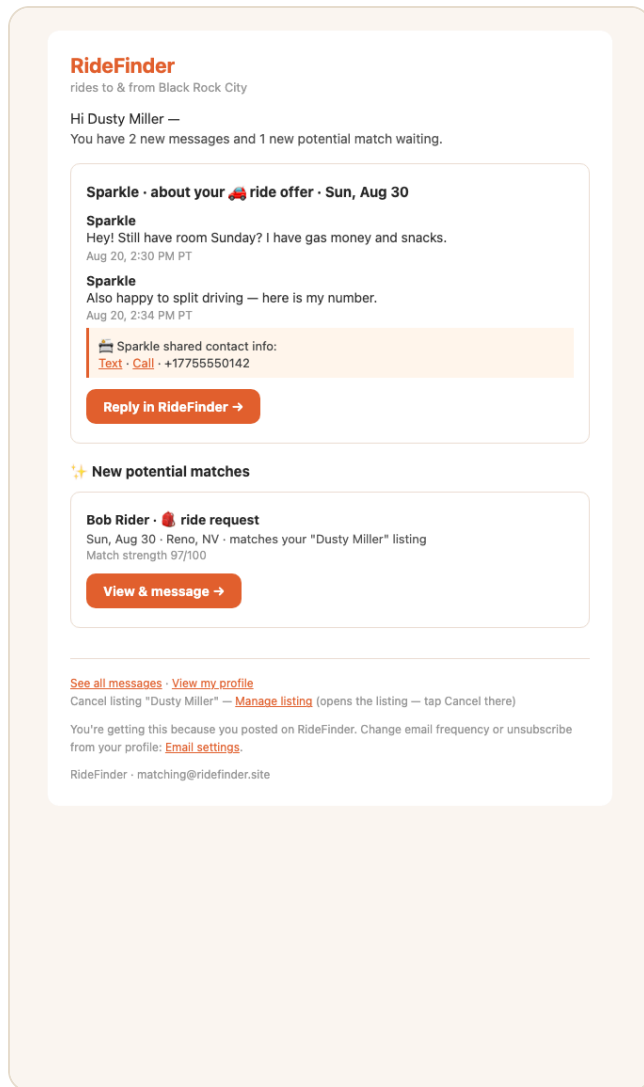


Each match explains itself in plain English — “Same day · Same area · Gear fits” — with a 0–100 strength ring. Message the good ones directly from here.

- The **Matches** tab lists everything compatible with your active listings, best first.
- A banner on the board (“🌟 2 potential matches for your listings”) appears whenever there’s something new.
- New matches also arrive in your email digest — no need to keep checking.

6 Email that respects your inbox

RideFinder emails you from `matching@ridefinder.site` only when something actually happened: new messages, or new potential matches.



A digest: messages grouped by conversation, tap-to-reply buttons, shared contact as one-tap text/call links, new matches, and manage-links at the bottom.

Pick your pace

On **You** → **Email me about new messages:**

- **Instantly** — within a minute
- **Hourly** — the default, one tidy roll-up
- **Daily** — one email a day
- **Never** — check the app yourself

Every email includes

- Reply buttons that land you in the exact conversation, logged in
- One-tap *Text* / *Call* / *Email* links when contact was shared
- Links to see all messages, manage or cancel your listings, and change frequency or unsubscribe

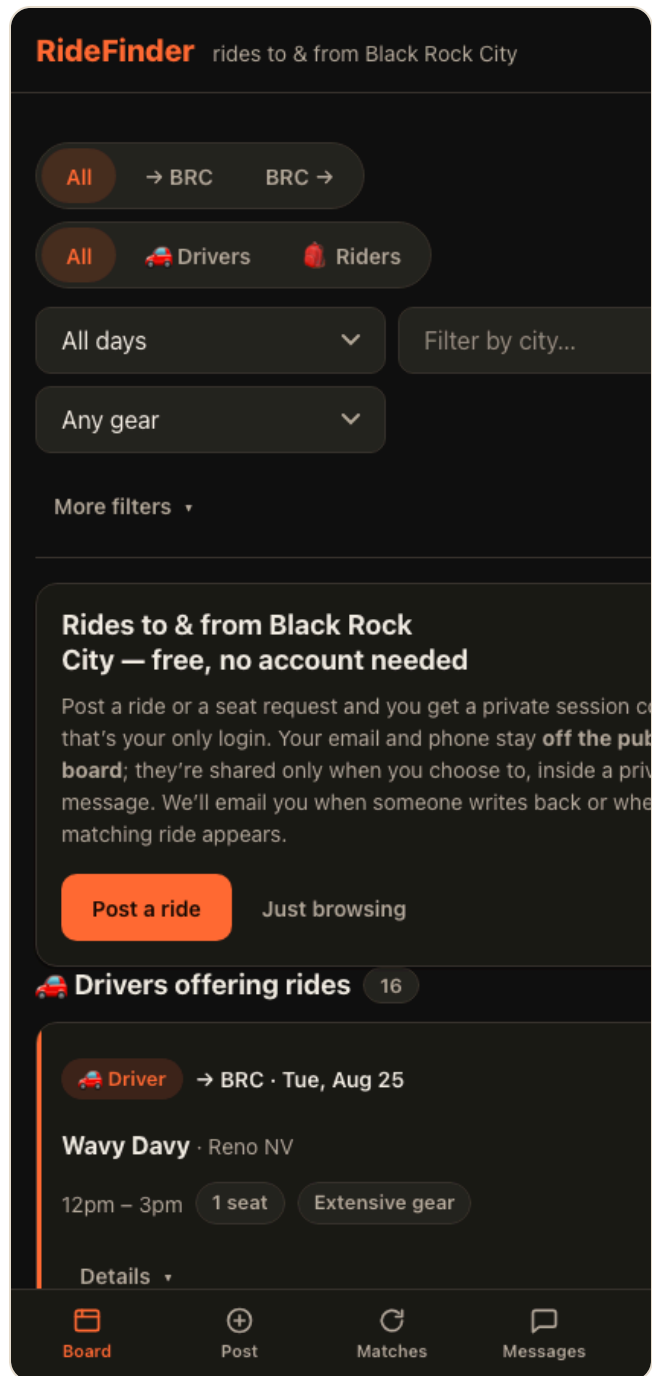
7 Works offline, installs like an app

On bad connections (i.e., the playa)

- The app and the last board you saw load instantly, connection or not.
- Offline, an amber bar shows how fresh your data is: *"Offline — showing rides from 23 min ago."*
- Anything you post or send while offline is queued with a "Waiting to sync" tag and sends itself — exactly once — when signal returns.

Install it

- **Android / Chrome:** accept the "Install RideFinder" banner, or menu → Add to Home screen.
- **iPhone / Safari:** Share ↑ → *Add to Home Screen*.



Phone layout: bottom tabs — Board, Post, Matches, Messages, You.

8 Safety, etiquette & FAQ

Etiquette

- Cancel listings you no longer need (You → Cancel listing) — it keeps the board honest.
- Drivers: be clear about gas splits and departure windows. Riders: be honest about gear.
- Something off about a listing? Use → **Report listing**. Reported listings are hidden automatically after multiple reports and reviewed.

FAQ

QUESTION	ANSWER
Do I need an account?	No. Posting creates a private session; the session code is your login.
Who can see my phone/email?	Nobody, until you tick a share box inside a specific message — then only that person.
What if I lose my session code?	Open it from any device where you're still signed in (You tab), or use any magic link from a RideFinder email. No email on file + no code = fresh start.
Why did my listing disappear?	Listings retire a few hours after their travel window. Flip on "Show recently expired" in More filters to see the last 7 days.
Does it cost anything?	No. Community project, no ads, no data selling.
Is my stuff private?	Messages are private between participants. Moderators can act on reported content. Sessions can be revoked any time by signing out.

RideFinder · ridefinder.site · questions & feedback: matching@ridefinder.site · Not affiliated with Burning Man Project. Ride at your own judgment — meet in public spots for first pickups and trust your instincts, on and off playa.